

The market research industry in France, *in figures.*

mazeo references every player of the market research world in France: over 13,000 professionals, in over 1,300 companies, clients and suppliers alike, and gathers all the data about them. We analysed this base to draw a portrait of the industry: who does research, in which companies, in which words, and how it all moves.

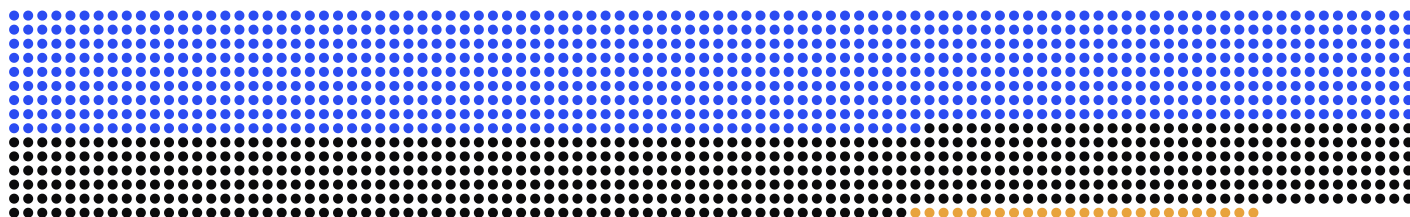
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**14,894 research
professionals, one dot for ten**

MAZEО DATABASE, 7 OCTOBER
2026



● **8,651**
on the client side

● **5,992**
on the supplier side

● **251**
in research bodies, schools and associations

Clients: the companies that buy research.
Suppliers: agencies, fieldwork and panel
companies, consulting, media agencies,
tool vendors.

58%

of research professionals work on the client side

40% on the supplier side, 2% elsewhere.

3

is the median number of research professionals per company

In a large group the median is 12; in an SME, 1.

33%

changed jobs less than two years ago

A trade where contacts move fast.

15yrs

of experience, median

Half of the professionals have over fifteen years in the trade.

66%

women

In company leadership, 56%.

844 clients and 424 suppliers *referenced.*

1,355 companies have at least one research professional in the mazeo database. Clients are the companies that buy research; suppliers are those that carry it out or equip it: agencies, fieldwork and panel companies, consulting, media agencies, tool vendors. Plus 87 research bodies, schools and associations.

WHAT IT MEANS

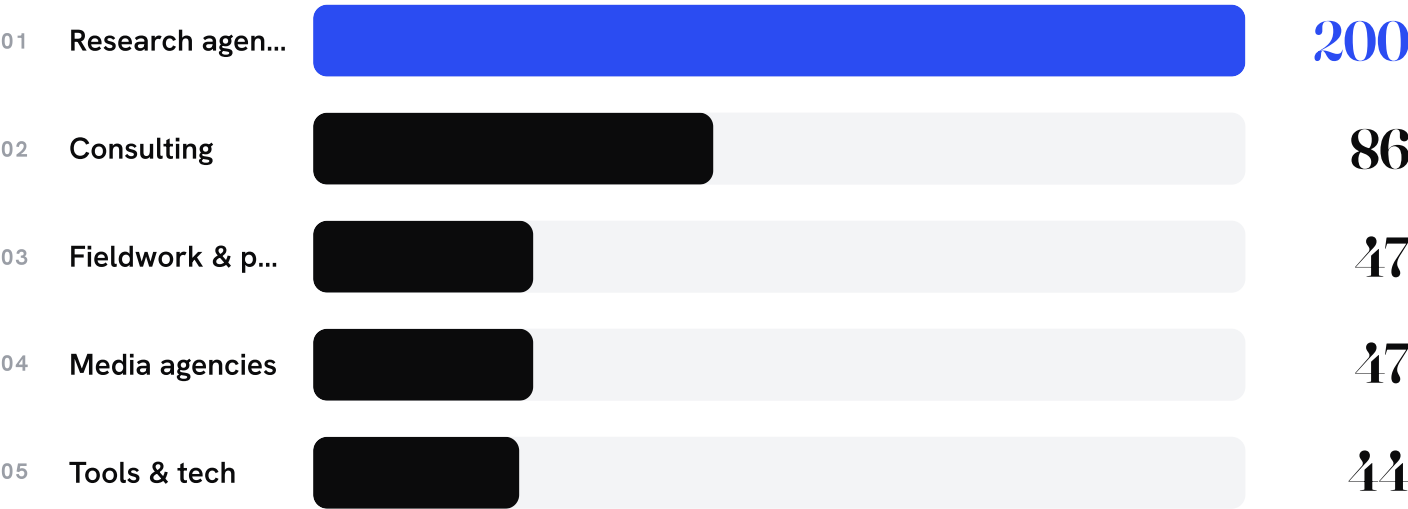
Two companies out of three in the industry are clients. Among suppliers, one in two is a research agency; the others are consulting, fieldwork and panel companies, media agencies and tool vendors.

1,355 REFERENCED COMPANIES, BY TYPE

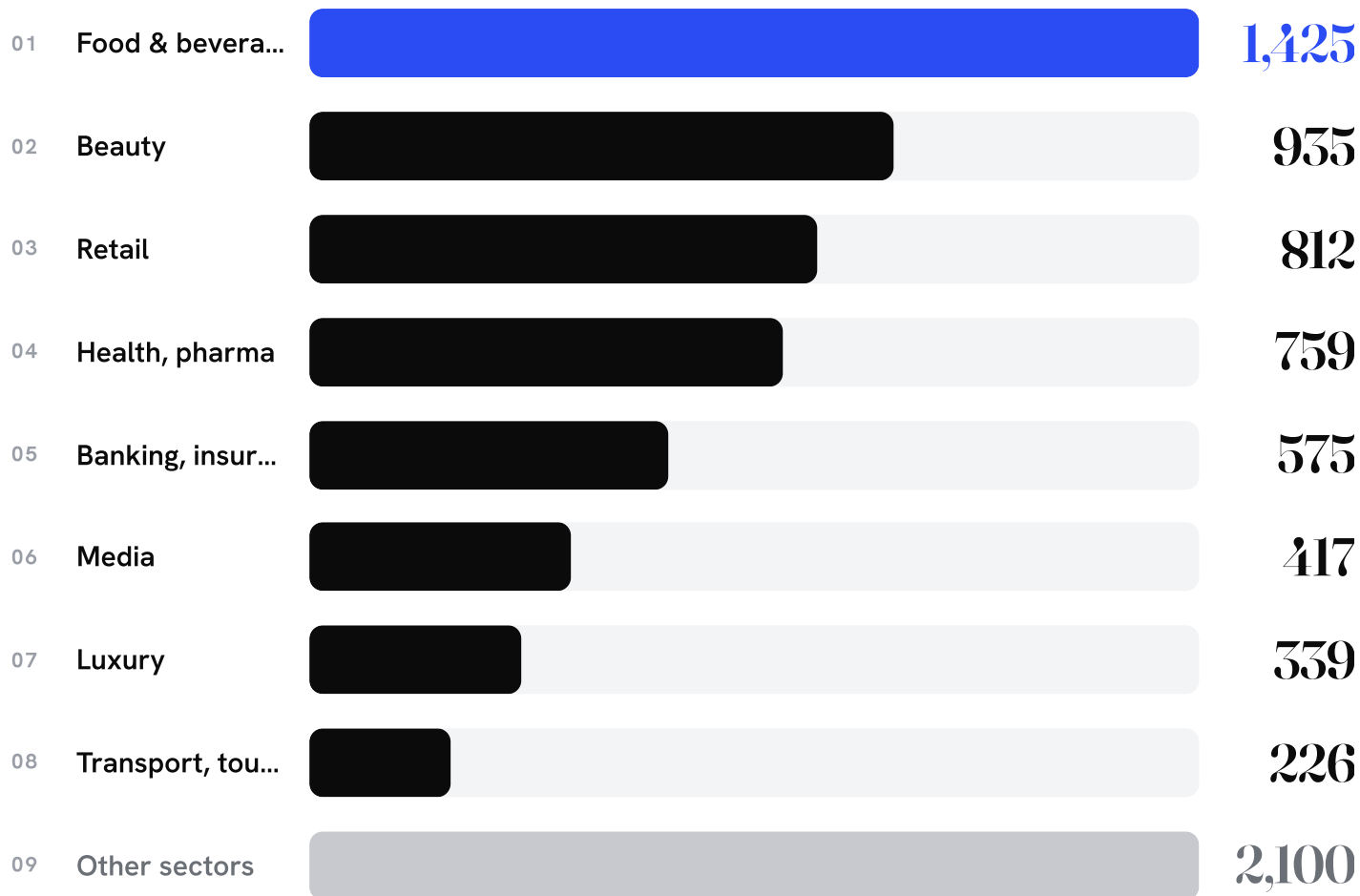


Clients **62%** · Suppliers **31%** · plus 87 research bodies, schools and associations (**6%**).

424 SUPPLIERS, BY TRADE

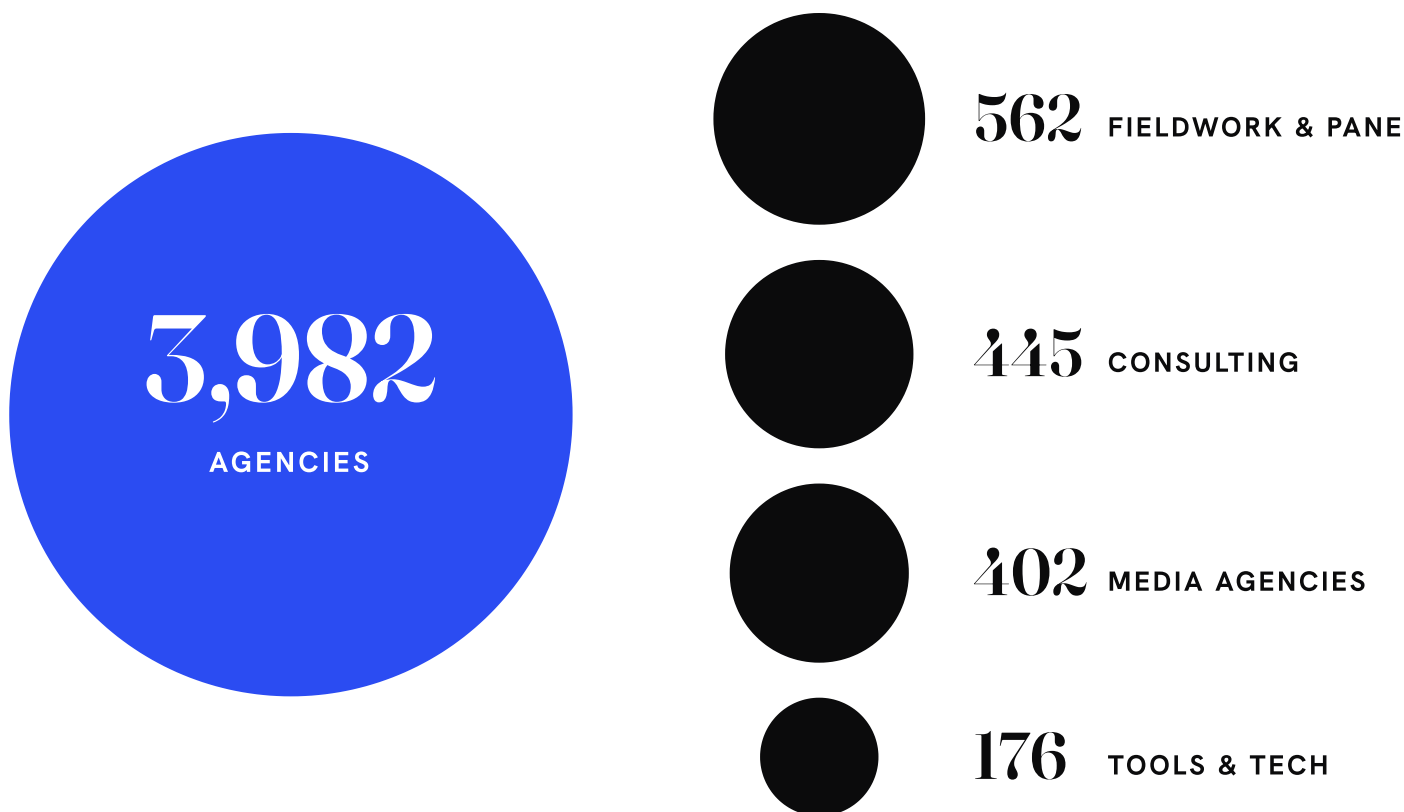


7,588 RESEARCH PROFESSIONALS ON THE CLIENT SIDE, BY SECTOR



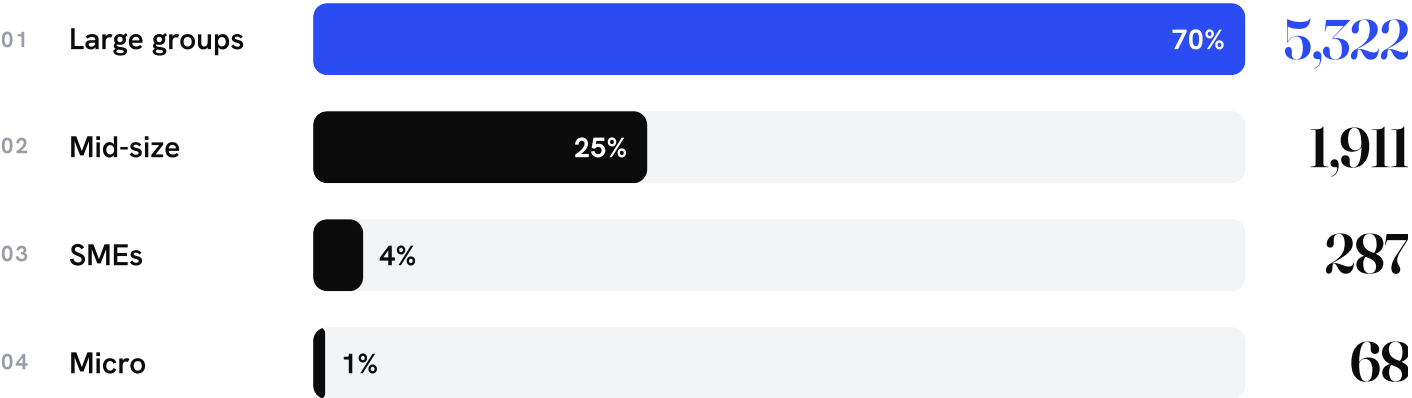
Sector of the company record.

5,567 RESEARCH PROFESSIONALS ON THE SUPPLIER SIDE, BY TRADE



The area of each circle is proportional to the number of professionals.

RESEARCH PROFESSIONALS ON THE CLIENT SIDE, BY COMPANY SIZE



Three is the median number of research professionals *per company*.

Half of the companies have three research professionals or fewer. In a large group the median is twelve; in a mid-size company, three; in an SME, one. One company in three has only one.

WHAT IT MEANS

The size of the research team follows the size of the company. Very large teams remain rare: twenty-one companies have more than fifty.

MEDIAN NUMBER OF RESEARCH PROFESSIONALS PER COMPANY, BY SIZE



On the client side. The largest teams: Sephora 161, E.Leclerc 120, Coty 119, L'Oréal 118.

On the client side, “insight” has almost caught up with “études”.

In client job titles, there are 74 “insight” for every 100 “études” (the French word for research). In research agencies, 16 per 100: the word is five times rarer there.

WHAT IT MEANS

The vocabulary of the trade changes on the client side first, and it changes with generations: “insight” appears in 4% of positions taken before 2018, and 10% of those taken since 2024.

74

ON THE CLIENT SIDE

“insight” per 100 “études” in job titles

16

IN RESEARCH AGENCIES

“insight” per 100 “études” in job titles

04 THE MOVES

Side switches mostly go from suppliers *to clients*.

Since July 2026, 24 research professionals have switched sides. Of these 24 moves, 19 go from a supplier to a client, 5 the other way.

WHAT IT MEANS

When leaving a supplier, moving to a client is the most frequent path. The reverse exists, but four times less.

BREAKDOWN OF THE 24 SIDE SWITCHES

79%

FROM A SUPPLIER TO A CLIENT

21%

FROM A CLIENT TO A SUPPLIER

Among the clients that welcomed a professional coming from a supplier: McDonald's, Givaudan, Pernod Ricard, Deezer, Mastercard, Orange, Coty, Bonduelle.

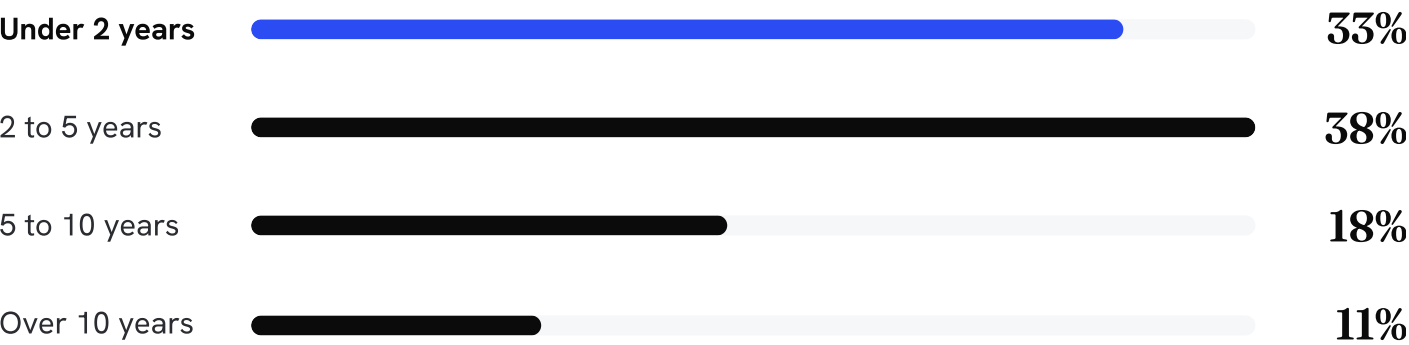
One research professional in three has been in their position for *less than two years*.

Tenure in the current position: 33% for less than two years, including 14% for less than one year.

WHAT IT MEANS

The research trade sees a high turnover of positions: within two years, one contact in three has changed.

TENURE IN THE CURRENT POSITION



Six research job offers out of ten are published *by clients*.

418 offers collected from April to September 2026 at the companies in the database: 253 at clients, 139 at suppliers. Nearly one offer in two is an internship or apprenticeship; the roles sought are research and insight first, then data.

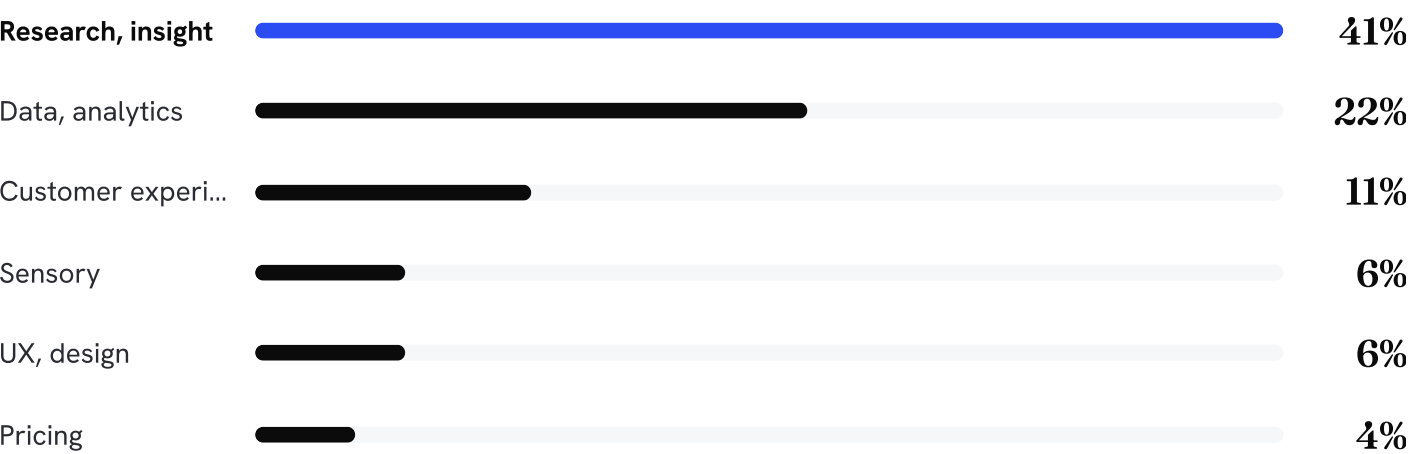
WHAT IT MEANS

A job offer at a client is a signal: a research team that grows, needs that grow.

BY LEVEL



BY TRADE



Classified from the job title. 11% other roles (project manager, marketing, merchandising). On the client side, the top recruiters: Lactalis 11 offers, Groupe BPCE 7, Chanel 7.

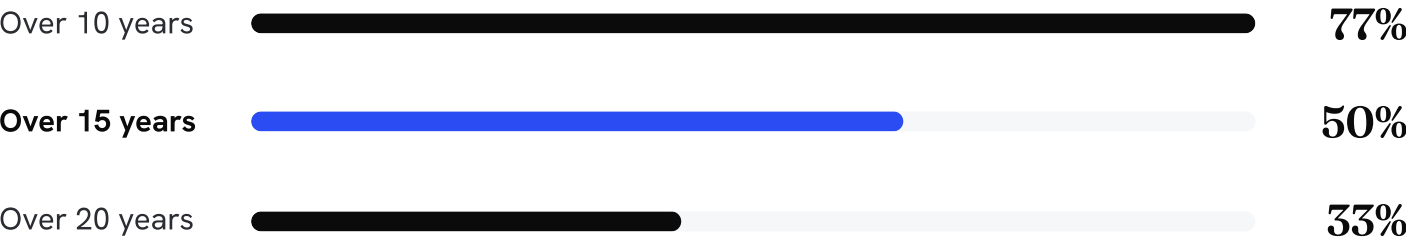
A trade of *experienced* people.

Half of research professionals have over fifteen years in the trade. Three in four have over ten, one in three over twenty.

WHAT IT MEANS

Beginners are rare in research teams: fewer than one professional in four has less than ten years in the trade.

SHARE OF PROFESSIONALS BY TOTAL EXPERIENCE



Total experience declared on the profile, 11,228 profiles filled in. Four employers, median.

Ten agencies employ *half* of the research professionals working in agencies.

200 agencies, 3,982 research professionals. Seven per agency, median, and 36 agencies have only one.

WHAT IT MEANS

The agency world is concentrated at the top and scattered at the bottom: ten large houses on one side, 190 agencies of seven people, median, on the other.

51%

IN TEN AGENCIES

2,042 research professionals

49%

IN THE OTHER 190

1,940 research professionals

Agencies with at least one research professional in the database.

Relative to its size, luxury is the sector *densest* in research professionals.

Per 1,000 employees in France, luxury has 31 research professionals, beauty 25, health 22, banking 4. In volume, food and beverage employs the most, ahead of beauty and retail.

WHAT IT MEANS

Two complementary readings: food and beverage weighs by its size, luxury and beauty by the place they give to research.

RESEARCH PROFESSIONALS PER 1,000 EMPLOYEES IN FRANCE, ON THE CLIENT SIDE



Headcount in France from the register, sectors with at least 12 companies of known headcount.

More than one research professional in two works *in the Paris region.*

8,275 research professionals in the Paris region, and two head offices out of three. Lyon comes far behind, with 611.

WHAT IT MEANS

The trade is highly concentrated in Paris. Outside the Paris region, Lyon, Lille and Toulouse are the three leading hubs.

RESEARCH PROFESSIONALS BY PLACE OF WORK



Location declared on the profile.

Two research professionals out of three come from a *business school*.

64% went through a business or management school.
Marketing 47%, statistics 10%, social sciences 10%.

WHAT IT MEANS

Research recruits first from business schools and marketing tracks. Statisticians and social sciences remain a minority, at 10% each.

SCHOOLS MOST CITED IN PROFILES



Number of research professionals who attended the school. Several degrees per person are possible.

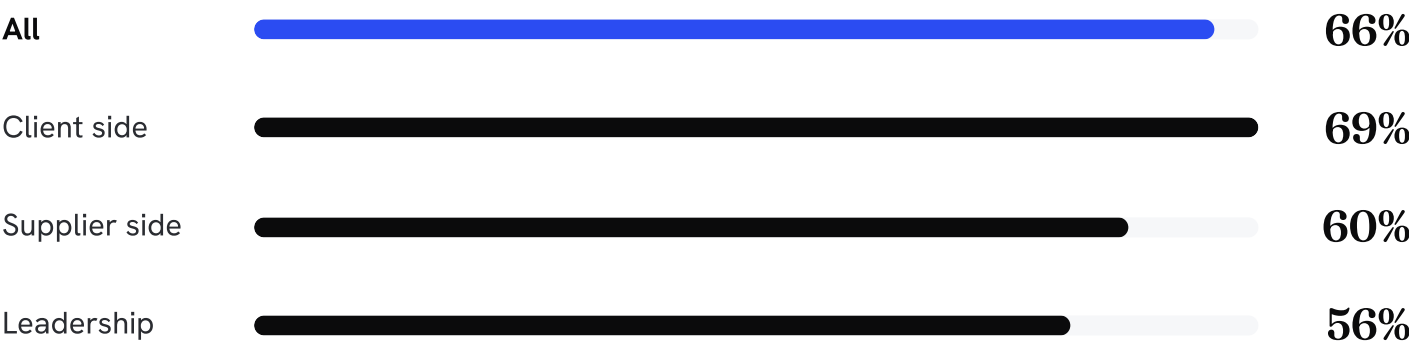
Two research professionals out of three are *women*.

In company leadership, a little over one in two. The gap is the same on the client side and on the supplier side.

WHAT IT MEANS

The trade is largely female, and leadership a little less so: 56% versus 66%.

SHARE OF WOMEN



Estimated from first names, INSEE file, 95% of first names recognised. Leadership: executives, VPs and directors.

Public procurement of research *is growing*.

190 public research contracts awarded in 2023, 269 in 2025. €204M over three years, conservative amount, €100k per contract, median.

WHAT IT MEANS

The number of public research contracts grew by 42% in two years. Six winners out of ten won only one contract: public buyers work with many different agencies. mazeo lists these tenders every day, sorts them by research trade and links to each notice, on Dernier appel. You can sign up to receive them every Monday.

PUBLIC RESEARCH CONTRACTS AWARDED, BY YEAR



DECP data. Part of the rise comes from better reporting since 2024.

mazeo has mapped the whole market research industry in France: over 1,300 companies and over 13,000 professionals, and the database grows every day. mazeo is the only prospecting tool built for market research.

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Method. mazeo database on 7 October 2026: 14,894 public profiles in 1,355 companies in France, archived included. Women and men estimated from first names (INSEE 2022 file, threshold of 20 births). Moves and job offers: signals collected by mazeo since 12 July 2026. Public contracts: French open data on public procurement (DECP).

Limits. Profiles without a date or an education do not count in the related percentages. Moves cover three months. Every figure is recalculated the day before it is published.